



MEMERY



THE MEMERY GUIDE TO

Starting a Corporate Podcast

How to create something people actually want to hear - and remember.

BEFORE YOU BUY THE MICROPHONES

Should your organisation start a podcast?

Maybe. A podcast can build familiarity, authority and trust over time. It gives you something most marketing formats struggle to earn: sustained attention.

But "we should probably have a podcast" is not a strategy. It is a reliable way to produce six episodes that nobody listens to.

Give the podcast a job.

The strongest corporate podcasts are built to do something useful: own a subject, educate a market, build a community, humanise senior leaders, recruit talent, deepen customer relationships or open doors with people the organisation wants to know.

The test: finish this sentence before you do anything else: **"In 12 months, this podcast will have succeeded if ____."** If you cannot complete it clearly, work on that first.

A GOOD REASON

Build a category association

Create a consistent connection between your organisation and an idea, problem or buying situation you want to own.

A BAD REASON

"Everyone else has one"

A medium is not a strategy. A clear audience, a distinctive premise and a sustainable production model come first.



FIND YOUR TERRITORY

Start with the audience. Then decide what you want to be remembered for.

The first mistake is asking, "What do we want to talk about?" The better question is: **what would our audience voluntarily spend 30 minutes listening to?**



Attention is useful. Memory is better. A strong show repeatedly connects your brand with a relevant idea, need or occasion. Over time, that association becomes easier to retrieve when a buying situation arises.

The job is not to make every episode "viral". The job is to make the organisation easier to recall, for more of the moments in which choice happens. Strategy determines what you need to be remembered for. Storytelling makes it stick.

CHOOSE THE SHOW, NOT JUST THE TOPIC

Pick a repeatable format that fits the job.

You do not need to reinvent broadcasting. You do need a structure that your audience can recognise and your team can produce repeatedly.

FORMAT	BEST FOR	WATCH OUT FOR
Interview	Borrowed credibility, relationships, guest networks, B2B ecosystem building.	Generic chats with no angle. The show is only as good as the questions and guests.
Expert explainer	Short, useful episodes that answer one question or unpack a complex issue.	Can feel thin without a distinctive perspective.
Panel	Multiple perspectives, debates and conference extensions.	Scheduling, cross-talk and editing complexity.
Narrative series	Customer stories, deep brand-building and premium storytelling.	Heavy scripting, sound design and longer lead times.
Solo / executive commentary	Clear leadership voice, category point of view, rapid publishing.	Requires strong writing and a host genuinely worth listening to.
Internal / external hybrid	Employees, customers and outside experts around one defined theme.	Drifting into internal news that outsiders do not care about.

Cadence: a consistent monthly or fortnightly show beats a weekly show that burns out by episode six. Choose the frequency your organisation can sustain with quality.

HOSTING AND GUESTS

Find a host, not a spokesperson.

The best host is not automatically the CEO, CMO or most senior available executive. Hosting is a skill.

A good host...

- is curious enough to ask the obvious question.
- actually listens instead of waiting to speak.
- knows when to interrupt - and when not to.
- can abandon the approved question list when something interesting happens.
- sounds like a human being, not a media-trained press release.

Good conversation beats corporate polish. Every time.

THE GUEST-AS-RELATIONSHIP ENGINE

For B2B organisations, some of the biggest value may come from the recording process itself. An interview is a legitimate reason to spend an hour with someone you want to know better.

01

Identify

Prospects, partners, customers and industry voices whose insight fits the show.

02

Invite

Lead with the value of their expertise, not your pipeline.

03

Interview

Build rapport through a genuinely useful conversation.

04

Extend

Share clips and continue the relationship without turning it into a hard sell.

Important: impressive titles do not guarantee interesting episodes. Pick guests for what they add for the listener first.



BUILD SOMETHING YOU CAN KEEP MAKING

Ten great episodes beat fifty mediocre ones.

Do not begin with "we are publishing every Tuesday forever". Begin with a genuinely good first season. For many organisations, six to ten strong episodes is enough to test the premise, learn what works and build a repeatable operating rhythm.

Editorial rule: if you cannot list at least ten genuinely interesting episode ideas before you launch, the concept probably is not ready.

SOUND MATTERS MORE THAN THE SET

Listeners will forgive simple. They will not forgive terrible audio.

Good production is not about making a boardroom look like a television studio. It is about removing the friction that makes people stop listening.

MICROPHONES**Use proper microphones**

One per person. Dynamic microphones are usually forgiving in offices because they reject more background noise and room reflections.

ROOM**Choose soft over impressive**

Glass walls, concrete floors and tall ceilings create echo. Smaller carpeted rooms with curtains, soft furnishings or acoustic treatment are easier to make sound good.

REMOTE**Record locally when possible**

Dedicated remote recording tools can capture each participant locally instead of relying on compressed video-call audio.

EDITING**Cut the boring parts**

Remove false starts, technical interruptions and long digressions. Transcript-based tools can speed the work, but editorial judgement still matters.

VIDEO**Capture video at the same time**

If the budget allows, one recording can feed the podcast, YouTube, vertical clips, social and presentations.

IDENTITY**Make it recognisable**

Use a consistent opening, closing, sonic identity, visual system and episode structure. Do not turn it into a radio ad.

Technical note: consistent dialogue loudness matters more than chasing studio perfection. Around -16 LUFS for stereo is a common podcast delivery target.



THE EPISODE IS ONLY THE BEGINNING

Record once. Create many times.

A 40-minute conversation should not become one audio file and a LinkedIn post saying "new episode out now". Treat the recording as the raw material for a wider content system.

FULL RECORDING**Audio episode + full video**

Podcast apps, YouTube, website

BEST MOMENTS**3-5 vertical video clips**

LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube Shorts and other social channels

KEY QUOTES**Pull quotes, audiograms and social posts**

Fast, recognisable brand content built around one idea

CORE THEMES**Article, transcript and show notes**

Website, search, internal knowledge and sales enablement

BIG IDEA**Newsletter + executive thought leadership**

Owned audience, bylines, speaking and follow-up conversations

The economics change when one recording becomes a content source. The podcast is no longer just an audio channel; it is a production engine for the wider marketing program.

MAKE IT FINDABLE

Publishing is not distribution.

Spotify, Apple Podcasts and YouTube can host or surface the show. They will not magically find the right audience for you.

Package every episode for discovery

- **Titles:** lead with the useful outcome, question or tension - not "Episode 12".
- **Show notes:** publish clear summaries, links, key takeaways and useful context on your own website.
- **Transcripts:** turn spoken expertise into searchable text and accessible content.
- **Chapters:** help people jump to the parts they care about.
- **Cover art:** bold, simple and legible at phone-thumbnail size.

Build the distribution system

- **Podcast host + RSS:** the technical backbone that syndicates episodes to directories.
- **YouTube:** important for video discovery, search and clips.
- **Owned channels:** website, newsletter, staff and executive networks.
- **Guest networks:** make it easy for guests to share polished assets.
- **Rights:** use guest releases and licensed music; define approval and regulatory sign-off before recording.

Consistency builds memory. Keep the show name, visual identity, host, tone, positioning and distinctive brand elements stable. Your internal team will get bored with them long before the audience does.

BEYOND DOWNLOADS

Measure the job the podcast was designed to do.

A niche show reaching 300 of exactly the right people can be more valuable than a broad show reaching thousands of people who will never buy, partner, refer or care.

Reach

Downloads, views, audience growth and new listeners.

Depth

Completion, returning listeners, time watched and qualitative feedback.

Business

Enquiries, influenced pipeline, sales usage, customer education and onboarding.

Memory

Branded search, category association, recall and whether the organisation is becoming easier to think of.

A practical attribution toolkit

01

Dedicated URL

Mention a memorable podcast landing page in the audio and track direct visits.

02

Self-reported source

Add "Where did you first hear about us?" to contact and enquiry forms.

03

CRM / pipeline notes

Track relationships and opportunities that began through guests, listeners or shared content.

04

Brand signals

Watch branded search, direct traffic, partner feedback and the specific association the show is designed to build.

The strategic question: is the podcast strengthening the association you wanted to own? If the answer is yes, you are measuring something closer to the real job.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Most corporate podcasts fail in remarkably predictable ways.

1**Too focused on the organisation**

Products, awards and executives instead of the audience's problems. **Fix:** make the listener the protagonist.

2**Impressive guests, nothing to say**

Titles do not create insight. **Fix:** look for relevance, perspective and storytelling ability.

3**Too long because nobody edits**

Cutting is a kindness. **Fix:** remove repetition, dead air and self-indulgent detours.

4**An unsustainable cadence**

Weekly ambition becomes monthly apologies. **Fix:** batch-record and maintain a finished buffer.

5**Over-promotional tone**

Listeners can smell the sales pitch. **Fix:** overwhelmingly lead with value; keep overt promotion light.

6**Content siloing**

The audio goes live and the job is considered finished. **Fix:** plan repurposing before you record.

7**Changing the brand constantly**

Internal boredom destroys external recognition. **Fix:** let distinctive assets compound over time.

8**Stopping too soon**

Audiences and memory build slowly. **Fix:** commit to the season and judge it against the original objective.

The biggest failure: treating "publish a podcast" as the objective. It is not. The objective is to create something worth listening to.

BEFORE YOU RECORD EPISODE ONE

Five questions that should have clear answers.

☐**1. Who exactly are we making this for?**

Not "business leaders". Define the role, sector, stage, needs and context precisely enough to know what they care about.

☐**2. Why would they voluntarily listen?**

What do they get that is useful, surprising, entertaining, clarifying or hard to get elsewhere?

☐**3. What do we want to be remembered for?**

Name the idea, problem, category or buying situation the show should reinforce over time.

☐**4. Can we identify at least ten genuinely interesting episodes?**

If not, the territory is probably too weak, too broad or too organisation-centric.

☐**5. Do we have a realistic distribution and repurposing plan?**

Decide how every episode becomes video, clips, written content, social, email and useful sales or stakeholder assets.

PRODUCTION**Also decide before launch**

Host, format, cadence, recording environment, equipment, editing, approval workflow, music rights, guest releases, hosting platform and reporting.

CAPACITY**Be honest about the work**

Strategy, guest research, scheduling, recording, editing, design, show notes, clips, publishing, promotion and measurement all require somebody's time.



ONE LAST THING

Don't make a corporate podcast.
Make a good podcast that happens to be made by a corporation.

The audience should get something useful, surprising, entertaining or genuinely interesting from every episode. Get that right and the brand benefits. Get it backwards and you have another piece of corporate content competing desperately for attention.

Thinking about starting one?

Memery can help with positioning, format development, hosting, guest strategy, audio and video production, distribution, content repurposing and measurement - whether you need a sounding board before you start or someone to build the whole thing with you.

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